

YANG, XUETING

Department of Economics and Related Studies, University of York, York, YO10 5DD

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EDUCATION

09/2023 – 2027 (Expected) University of York, Department of Economics and Related Studies York, UK

Ph.D., Economics

Dissertation: *Individual decision-making in ambiguous (and risky) situations*

Expected thesis submission: November 2026

09/2020 – 03/2022 Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou Suzhou, China

MSc, Economics and Finance (with Distinction)

09/2015 – 07/2019 Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou Suzhou, China

BSc, Economics and Finance (with First-class Honours)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Experimental and Behavioural Economics, with a focus on decision-making under risk and ambiguity, consumer behaviour, and applied microeconomic theory.

PUBLICATIONS & PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

Yang, X., & Hey, J. (2025). **Do workers maximize expected utility when choosing labour contracts under ambiguity?** *Journal of Risk and Uncertainty*, 71(3), 273–292. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11166-025-09470-w>

- **“Less Is More”: Decision-Making under Increasingly Complex Ambiguity** (*Revision, Journal of Risk and Uncertainty*)

Examines whether increasingly complex decisions under ambiguity require more parameterized behavioural models. Using a laboratory allocation experiment and individual-level model comparison, the paper compares Expected Utility (EU), α MaxMin (AMM), and Choquet Expected Utility (CEU) across ambiguous choice environments of increasing structural complexity. EU is most frequently selected by AICc across all three ambiguous-lottery tasks, although its relative advantage varies across tasks and CEU remains competitive in the most complex setting.

- **Probability Misperception in Blind Box Consumption: An Experimental Investigation of Risk and Ambiguity Preferences** (*Major Revisions, Theory and Decision*)

Uses laboratory experiments (BDM mechanism) to test whether consumers overestimate low-probability outcomes. Results show systematic overestimation, particularly among risk-seeking individuals, suggesting that probability misperception may help explain demand for blind boxes.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Cognitive Ability and Belief Formation under Ambiguity

- Examines how cognitive ability shapes the precision and calibration of subjective beliefs under ambiguity, using incentivised laboratory experiments and measures of risk and ambiguity preferences.

AWARDS & FUNDING

- *Departmental PhD Studentship Funding*, University of York, 2023-2027
- *2025-2026 Award for Outstanding Overseas Study Elite*, China Scholarship Council, 2026
- *Teaching Excellence Award*, University of York, 2025

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

- 06/2026 *ASFEE 2026: Annual Conference of the French Association of Experimental Economics*, Lille, France. (Oral Presentation)
- 06/2026 *2026 CMID (conference on Mechanism and Institution Design)*, York, UK. (Member of local organization committee)
- 06/2026 *FUR (Foundations of Utility and Risk) Conference 2026*, Alicante, Spain. (Oral Presentation)
- 05/2026 *2026 Durham-Edinburgh-York Workshop*, Durham, UK. (Oral Presentation)
- 03/2026 *ECO Department Brownbag Seminar*, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, Suzhou, China. (Presenter)
- 10/2025 *Departmental Thursday Workshop*, University of York, York, UK. (Presenter)
- 06/2025 *ASFEE 2025: 15th Conference of the French Experimental Economics Association*, Nancy, France. (Oral Presentation & Poster session)
- 06/2025 *ESA 2025 World Meeting*, Beijing, China. (Oral Presentation)
- 08/2024 *2024 SABE/IAREP Conference*, Dundee, UK. (Poster Session)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of York, Department of Economics and Related Studies

York, UK

Teaching Assistant

Microeconomic Theory (Undergraduate), 09/2024 – 02/2026

- Led tutorials on core microeconomic concepts and problem-solving; supported students' analytical and mathematical reasoning and provided feedback on assessed work.

Probability and Statistics (Undergraduate), 02/2025 – 06/2025

- Delivered small-group tutorials on probability and statistical methods, guiding students in applying theoretical concepts to practical problems.

Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou

Suzhou, China

Teaching Assistant

Experimental Economics and Finance (Undergraduate), 09/2021 – 12/2021

- Supported classroom experiments by explaining procedures and economic concepts, facilitating discussions, and guiding students in interpreting experimental outcomes.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGE

Software & Programming

- **Experimental programming:** Visual Studio (C#/.NET), z-Tree; developed custom Windows Forms applications for risk/ambiguity elicitation, BDM mechanisms, and complexity treatments.
- **Quantitative analysis:** MATLAB, R, STATA; behavioural data analysis and econometric modelling.

- **Languages** Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (basic), Thai (beginner)

REFERENCES

Professor John Hey

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